The Secret Menu Index

THE NINE OPERATIONS

Nine things a magician does. Your training runs eight of them, unlabeled. This page names each one, where it already lives in what you do, and the receipt: the word in your own vocabulary that proves it. One operation per lesson on the channel. Every claim carries its source, edition named. A map, not medical advice, and not a list of treatments for sale.

01 **Divination.** In your clinic: three fingers, both wrists; the tongue; the face; the intake. What it is: reading one surface for information it has no business carrying. The receipt: 脈象 (mài xiàng), pulse image, not pulse rate; 象 is the character the Yijing uses for what a diviner reads out of a hexagram. Operation 1, on video: **watch the lesson →**

Sources. Nigel Wiseman and Feng Ye, A Practical Dictionary of Chinese Medicine (Paradigm Publications, 1998); Elisabeth Hsu, Pulse Diagnosis in Early Chinese Medicine: The Telling Touch (Cambridge University Press, 2010).

02 **Correspondence, the engine.** In your clinic: the five-phase table; the five flavours and the organs they enter; magnetite, dragon bone and pearl to settle the spirit. What it is: like affects like, and what was once in contact stays connected. The receipt: 五味所入, the five flavours and where they enter, in the Su Wen. Operation 2, next lesson.

Sources. 黃帝內經素問 (Huangdi neijing suwen), 宣明五氣; Paul U. Unschuld and Hermann Tessenow, Huang Di Nei Jing Su Wen: An Annotated Translation (University of California Press, 2011); James Frazer, The Golden Bough (1890), on the two branches.

03 **Talismans.** In your clinic: nothing. This one was cut. What it is: writing something down so the writing does the work. The receipt: 符 (fú), a split token whose two halves prove each other; 符水, talisman water; a whole scroll of them bound into Sun Simiao's formulary.

Sources. Sun Simiao, 千金翼方 (Qianjin yifang), juan 29 and 30, 禁經; Catherine Despeux, "Talismans and Diagrams," in Livia Kohn, ed., Daoism Handbook (Brill, 2000).

04 **Energy work.** In your clinic: the qigong course you passed, and the line before the needle: 凡刺之真，必先治神, for needling to be real, first govern the spirit. What it is: something in the body that can be built, moved, depleted and directed, and an operator conditioned to do it. The receipt: 行氣, circulate the qi, cut into a jade cylinder around 380 BCE; 導引圖 from Mawangdui, 168 BCE.

Sources. Donald Harper, Early Chinese Medical Literature: The Mawangdui Medical Manuscripts (Kegan Paul, 1998); 黃帝內經素問, chapter 25, 寶命全形論 (Unschuld and Tessenow, 2011).

05 **Gnosis.** In your clinic: the state you needle from. What it is: not a thing you do, the condition you do everything else from. The receipt: Su Wen 25, 如臨深淵，手如握虎，神無營於眾物, stand as if over an abyss, hold your hand as if holding a tiger, let the spirit stray to nothing; and 存思, the visualisation practice of the Shangqing line.

Sources. 黃帝內經素問, chapter 25 (Unschuld and Tessenow, 2011); Isabelle Robinet, Taoist Meditation: The Mao-shan Tradition of Great Purity (State University of New York Press, 1993).

06 **Illumination.** In your clinic: the nourishing-life material, 養生, demoted to an elective. What it is: the operation where you are the material and the work is that you come out different. The receipt: the first juan of Sun Simiao's formulary, 大醫習業 on what a physician has to study and 大醫精誠 on the absolute sincerity of the great physician, placed before a single prescription.

Sources. Sun Simiao, 備急千金要方 (Beiji qianjin yaofang), juan 1; Paul U. Unschuld, Medicine in China: A History of Ideas (University of California Press, 1985).

07 **Banishing.** In your clinic: release the exterior, clear heat, drain damp, expel wind, the whole verb list. What it is: not fixing a person, evicting an occupant, then putting the place back in order. The receipt: 汗吐下, the three doors; 攻邪, attacking evil; 邪去而元氣自復, once the evil is gone the original qi restores itself, in Zhang Congzheng.

Sources. 張從正 Zhang Congzheng, 儒門事親 (Rumen shiqin), c. 1228; Fabien Simonis, "Illness, Texts, and 'Schools' in Danxi Medicine," in Benjamin A. Elman, ed., Antiquarianism, Language, and Medical Philology (Brill, 2015).

08 **Spirit work.** In your clinic: nothing. This one was cut. What it is: spirits called out and commanded, or called in and carried. The receipt: 祝由 (zhùyóu), a staffed state department for roughly a thousand years; 十三鬼穴, the Thirteen Ghost Points, in Sun Simiao's formulary of 652, juan 14, with names like 鬼宮 and 鬼壘 still on them.

Sources. Sun Simiao, 備急千金要方 (Beiji qianjin yaofang), juan 14; Philip S. Cho, "Healing and Ritual Imagination in Chinese Medicine: The Multiple Interpretations of Zhuyou," East Asian Science, Technology, and Medicine 38 (2013).

09 **The ninth.** Not in the Chinese record. The lens the other eight are read through: taking up a way of seeing on purpose, for what it lets you do, not because you have concluded it is true. Held back. That is the last lesson, and a conversation for much later.

Sources. Peter J. Carroll, Liber Null and Psychonaut (Weiser, 1987); Andrieh Vitimus, Hands-On Chaos Magic (Llewellyn, 2009).

What the curriculum cut

The deletion log. Every tradition is an operating system. Around 1950 this one got a forced update: the methods kept, the frame stripped, the update notes never published. This page is the deletion log, recovered from the record. Nine entries. Each names what it was, where the cut fell, where it is restored, and two sources, the primary text and a scholarly study. Every claim carries its source, edition named. A map, not medical advice, and not a list of treatments for sale.

01 祝由 **(zhùyóu), ritual healing by charm and spell.** What it was: a tested subject of the Yuan state medical academy, its own section on the official exam, beside acupuncture. The cut: filed out of medicine in the modern rebuild. Restored in the Menu: the full history, broken down. Spiritual practice, not healthcare. Same fence as the needles.

Sources. Philip S. Cho, Ritual and the Occult in Chinese Medicine and Religious Healing: The Development of Zhuyou Exorcism (PhD diss., University of Pennsylvania, 2005); Michel Strickmann, Chinese Magical Medicine (Stanford University Press, 2002).

02 十三鬼穴**, the Thirteen Ghost Points.** What it was: thirteen points, traditionally attributed to Sun Simiao, for what the tradition called ghost affliction. The cut: the points kept, the ghosts filed off. Restored in the Menu: the history, told straight. The needle work stays with trained hands; that line doesn't move.

Sources. Sun Simiao, 備急千金要方 (Beiji qianjin yaofang), juan 14, 風癲; Michel Strickmann, Chinese Magical Medicine (Stanford University Press, 2002).

03 禁經**, Sun Simiao's Book of Spellbinding.** What it was: talismans, incantations, exorcisms, demon-expelling points, bound into the same formulary as the 45-ingredient prescriptions. The cut: reclassified as an oddity, when it's read at all. Restored in the Menu: talked through generally and broken down where the record allows.

Sources. Sun Simiao, 千金翼方 (Qianjin yifang), juan 29 and 30, 禁經 upper and lower; Michel Strickmann, Chinese Magical Medicine (Stanford University Press, 2002).

04 符 **(fú), talismans.** What it was: encoded intention. Historically set down in the form of a warrant, worked inside living spirit relationships, with two thousand years of documented construction logic. The cut: filed under folk religion. Restored in the Menu: where they came from and how the tradition understood them.

Sources. Catherine Despeux, "Talismans and Diagrams," in Livia Kohn, ed., Daoism Handbook (Brill, 2000); Michel Strickmann, Chinese Magical Medicine (Stanford University Press, 2002), on ensigillation.

05 **Wǔ Yùn Liù Qì, the five movements and six qi.** What it was: the tradition's own timing model, written into the medical classics themselves. The cut: demoted to elective. Restored in the Menu: the model and how it was used, broken down.

Sources. 黃帝內經素問 (Huangdi neijing suwen), the seven great treatises, chapters 66 to 71 and 74; Paul U. Unschuld and Hermann Tessenow, Huang Di Nei Jing Su Wen: An Annotated Translation (University of California Press, 2011).

06 **The point names.** What it was: every acupoint name a small myth, a location, and an instruction encoded in two characters. The cut: reduced to numbers on a chart, LI-4, ST-36. Restored in the Menu: the names broken down, character by character, myth by myth.

Sources. Andrew Ellis, Nigel Wiseman and Ken Boss, Grasping the Wind (Paradigm Publications, 1989); Nigel Wiseman and Feng Ye, A Practical Dictionary of Chinese Medicine (Paradigm Publications, 1998).

07 **Divination as pattern perception.** What it was: the oracle read through the medical-cosmological frame, pattern-reading, not fortune-telling. The cut: carved out of medicine entirely. Restored in the Menu: the method, broken down.

Sources. Richard J. Smith, Fortune-tellers and Philosophers: Divination in Traditional Chinese Society (Westview Press, 1991); Elisabeth Hsu, Pulse Diagnosis in Early Chinese Medicine: The Telling Touch (Cambridge University Press, 2010).

08 **Cultivation as the practitioner's floor.** What it was: qigong, meditation, ritual hygiene as the daily core, the instrument before the formula. The cut: reduced to a course or two, a side hobby students get around to eventually. Restored in the Menu: what the daily practice actually was, with the exercises. This is where the practice lives.

Sources. Sun Simiao, 備急千金要方 (Beiji qianjin yaofang), juan 27, 養性; Livia Kohn, Chinese Healing Exercises: The Tradition of Daoyin (University of Hawai'i Press, 2008).

09 **The frame itself.** What it was: the cosmology that held all of the above as one project. The cut: swapped for materialist language in 1950-something and called the original. Restored in the Menu: the cosmology as history, then loaded and run.

Sources. Kim Taylor, Chinese Medicine in Early Communist China, 1945 to 63 (RoutledgeCurzon, 2005); Paul U. Unschuld, Medicine in China: A History of Ideas (University of California Press, 1985).

What the Menu teaches, and how to get in

The Secret Menu is where each operation on page one and each entry on page two gets broken down: what yin actually is, what yang actually is, what the point names encode, the mythology and the etymology under the terms, metaphor by metaphor, map by map. The points and the herbs the way a magician meets them: by their names, their myths, their correspondences. The exercises live where they belong, in the daily cultivation floor, written the way I practise: load the frame, run it, log what happens, keep what works.

THE FREE LAYER

The lessons, on video

Nine operations, one per lesson. Operation 1: pulse diagnosis, and the receipt is 脈象 (pulse image).
Watch the series →

This Index

The map of the nine operations, and the deletion log, with named sources under every entry. Read it once now. It reads differently after each lesson. Colleagues get theirs by email.
Send a colleague the Index →

The sample monograph

Garlic, 大蒜 (dà suàn), 24 pages on one herb, built on the Chinese record. The only free monograph.
Download the garlic monograph →

THE PAID ROOM

Join The Secret Menu.

EVERY MONTH
One live hour on an operation from this Index.

MISS IT LIVE
You get the recording, available while you stay subscribed.

AFTER GARLIC
Every new monograph is published to members only.

$75 CAD a month plus applicable tax.

Billed monthly until you cancel. Cancel anytime; cancelling stops the next charge. Founding members who joined by October 9, 2026 keep their founding rate while subscribed. The $75 rate is open to the first 20 members, who keep it while subscribed.

Join The Secret Menu →

This is education and energy practice, not medical treatment or diagnosis. No specific results are promised. Nothing in the Menu replaces care from your doctor, and the needle and the herb prescription stay with trained hands.